

Government organisation in eastern India. The Bihar Government too is willing to bet big on it now as the corporation isn't just confined to building bridges in the state; it has also ventured into new sectors like roads and building construction, besides undertaking beautification projects in the state capital, the most notable being the Patna Roads Project.

engineers was one of the biggest challenges we ever faced. Completion of only 314 bridges in the first 30 years of the corporation had led the engineers into believing that the projects were too big to be implemented," Amrit recalls. Many in the BRPNNL were of the belief that taking their salaries home was a much better and easier option than facing demanding contrac-

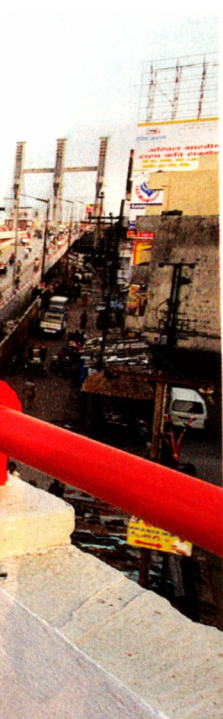
tors and unforgiving government authorities breathing down their necks. During intra-departmental discussions, the engineers would reject many government orders as unviable.

Knowing the importance of positive reinforcement, Amrit opted for an out-of-the-box solution to solve this mess. The corporation became the first Bihar government enterprise which roped in professional motivators to pep talk the dispirited engineers. Incentives, akin to the ones given in corporate India, were introduced. As part of his motivational strategy, the corporation's engineers were provided an SUV, a mobile phone, and plenty of administrative freedom. The best reward for those who would perform and deliver, however, was a foreign trip, an unheard of inducement in a government office. In short, the BRPNNL did everything to make its employees happy, comfortable and content. These measures introduced by the BRPNNL were reciprocated by enthusiastic employees at a rate that surprised everyone and even surpassed Amrit's fondest hopes too. The BRPNNL, which had completed 314 bridges during the first 30 years of its inception, has managed to successfully execute 336 bridges in just three years.

It is not just the mindset of employees that has changed in the last three years but also the BRPNNL office that has become the first Wi-Fi enabled office in Bihar—one that gives seamless connectivity to employees with laptops. In fact, the engineers, who were once reluctant to share their mobile numbers, have now willingly accepted installation of a software called Mobile Instructor in their cellphones, that makes them stay online, enabling Amrit to know their locations and stay in touch. The office now has a corporate look with a gymnasium—first again in Bihar. Thanks to positive thinking, today his engineers don't mind taking up risky projects like the Rampur bridge in Aurangabad district.

By completing projects in record time, the BRPNNL is not only building bridges, but also bridging the gap between Bihar and prosperity. ■

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Having overcome its blues, BRPNNL now has an order book that is swelling by the day. What made it possible? According to Amrit, it all happened thanks to a "clinical strategy that had humans at the centre". Beyond the jargon, the turnaround process was triggered by "doing the textbook things while keeping the basics right". A beginning was made when the state Government awarded a Rs 1,150-crore contract under the Mukhya Mantri Setu Nirman Yojna, giving a new lease of life to the ailing corporation.

But the task was easier said than done. "The negative mindset of our

Feat on the Ground

- On June 12, Nitish Kumar inaugurated 140 bridges built by BRPNNL across the state at one go.
- At present, BRPNNL is constructing 359 bridges, besides road strengthening projects at a cost of Rs 1,975 crore.
- It didn't face any public outcry even when they removed over a dozen roadside temples to construct roads.